ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** legally binding representation for women	It ensures a fair proportion
2	**(a)** regulates access to resources	Land and education were denied to some castes
3	**(a)** marriage within caste and untouchability still persist	Effects of past advantages remain
4	**(d)** Demanding government steps to protect religious minorities	As long as every religion is treated equally
5	**(b)** Followers of one religion have the same interests in every context	The first is the communal belief the chapter rejects
6	**(b)** two-thirds	About three-fourths of the Hindu population
7	**(d)** Sikh upper castes	It was 0.0 per cent
8	**(c)** Equal Remuneration Act, 1976	It provides equal wages for equal work
9	**(a)** men do such work when it is paid	Unpaid housework is considered women's job
10	**(d)** The Census counts the OBCs along with the SC and ST	The Census does not yet count OBCs

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Shift of population from rural to urban areas (1); One reason why caste hierarchy breaks down (1).	1+1
12	There is no state religion (1); It guarantees freedom of religion to all (1).	1+1
13	Special steps to prevent communal riots (1); Protection of religious minorities (1).	1+1
14	They include representatives of different castes and tribes (1); This helps political support (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Different family laws apply to followers of different religions (1); Women's movements argue they discriminate against women (1); They demand that laws be made equitable (1).	1+1+1
16	It gives equal status to all religions (1); It prevents domination of one religion (1); It protects freedom of conscience (1).	1+1+1
17	They had access to education and resources earlier (1); Lower castes were denied land and education (1); The effects of accumulated advantage continue (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Phule, Gandhiji, Ambedkar and Periyar worked for a society without caste inequalities (1); Their efforts and social changes changed the caste system (1); The Constitution prohibited caste discrimination (1).	1+1+1
18	Religious values and ideals can play a role in politics (1); People can express needs as members of a religious community (1); It is wrong only when one religion is presented as superior or used to dominate others (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It reduces the child sex ratio to 919 (1); In some States below 850 or 800 (1); It reflects preference for sons (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Records religion of every person (1); Hindus 79.8, Muslims 14.2, Christians 2.3 per cent (1); SC 16.6, ST 8.6 per cent in 2011 (1); OBC about 41 per cent from NSS (1); SC, ST and OBC together are about two-thirds of the population (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Gandhiji's ethics based politics (1); Human rights groups demand protection of minorities (1); Women's movement demands change in family laws (1); Becomes harmful when one religion is pitted against another (1); State power used for dominance (1).	1+1+1+1+1

20	Caste regulates access to resources (1); Old hierarchy still reflected in average economic status (1); Higher poverty among ST, SC (1); Upper castes over-represented among rich (1); Very rich and very poor exist in every caste now (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Helped Dalits and OBCs gain a share in decision making (1); Organisations demand dignity and land (1); Harmed by diverting attention from poverty, development and corruption (1); Can lead to tensions and violence (1); Balanced approach needed (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** caste is not the only factor in voting	Performance, party and leaders also matter
2	**(c)** Weather conditions	The others are in the chapter
3	**(b)** preference for sons and sex-selective abortion	The ratio fell below 850 in some States
4	**(a)** the Muslim proportion in the population is expected to rise only slightly	By about 3 to 4 per cent in 50 years
5	**(b)** communalism	The chapter says this belief is flawed
6	**(b)** sexual division of labour	Gender roles are social, not biological
7	**(b)** India has no state religion, Sri Lanka protects Buddhism	Contrast in the chapter
8	**(d)** Women are paid less than men even for the same work	The Equal Remuneration Act has not been fully effective
9	**(a)** ensure equality within religious communities	It bans untouchability for this reason
10	**(c)** Mahatma Gandhi	He meant ethics drawn from all religions

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A ladder-like formation of caste groups (1); Placed from the 'highest' to the 'lowest' (1).	1+1
12	It is unpaid (1); It is not income generating (1).	1+1
13	Women's issues do not get attention (1); Half of the population lacks adequate voice (1).	1+1
14	Parents prefer to spend resources on boys (1); Girls perform well but drop out (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	ST rural poverty 45.8 per cent (1); SC rural poverty 35.9 per cent (1); Hindu upper castes 11.7 per cent (1).	1+1+1
16	It involves common prejudices and stereotypes (1); It is so common that people fail to notice it even when they believe it (1); It includes beliefs in the superiority of one's religion (1).	1+1+1
17	India and Pakistan suffered some of the worst communal riots (1); The idea of religion as basis of nation was involved (1); Communalism remained a challenge afterwards (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Demanded reservation of at least one-third seats in Lok Sabha and Assemblies (1); Reservation in local bodies was won (1); A 2023 Act provides 33 per cent reservation (1).	1+1+1
18	India gives no special status to any religion (2); Buddhism is protected in Sri Lanka, Islam has a special status in Pakistan and Christianity in England (1).	2+1
	OR: People of the same caste do not share all interests (1); Caste is one aspect of experience, not the only one (1); Rich and poor of one caste differ (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Women's primary responsibility is seen as housework (1); Women do paid work too, but without recognition (1); Men take the public roles (1); Women's role in politics is minimal in most societies (1); Women's movements opened more fields (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Candidate selection by caste composition (1); Appeal to caste sentiment (1); Universal franchise (1); No constituency has a single caste majority (1); No party gets all votes of a caste (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Constitution is secular with no state religion (1); Freedom of religion and equality (1); Constitution is necessary but not sufficient (1); Citizens must counter prejudice in daily life (1); Politics must counter religious mobilisation (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: Low representation (14.36 per cent in Lok Sabha) (1); Women's issues receive inadequate attention (1); Reservation in local bodies has brought over 10 lakh women (1); Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023 (1); Fair proportion is ensured by law (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Combining with neighbouring sub-castes to become bigger	The chapter lists it
2	**(c)** political mobilisation on religious lines	A form of communalism
3	**(a)** Cabinets are largely all-male even when a woman is Chief Minister or Prime Minister	The chapter says so
4	**(c)** They had access to education under the old system	Groups that were prohibited from education lagged behind
5	**(a)** their work remains unpaid and invisible	Men's work mostly earns income
6	**(d)** Unless women control power, their problems will not get adequate attention	The chapter's reasoning
7	**(b)** support of more than one caste	Hence candidates reach across castes
8	**(a)** the role of caste in nominations	Parties muster necessary support
9	**(d)** political competition brings caste identities into the political arena	Politics changes caste identities too
10	**(a)** discriminate against women	They want government to make them more equitable

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They have different economic conditions (1); Their interests differ (1).	1+1
12	Shift from one occupation to another (1); Usually when a new generation takes up occupations other than their ancestors' (1).	1+1
13	People have several identities (1); There are many voices inside every community (1).	1+1
14	Men are valued more and have power (1); Women face disadvantage and discrimination (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Voters change preferences based on performance (1); If castes were frozen in their preferences this could not happen (1); So other factors matter (1).	1+1+1
16	Girls perform as well as boys in school results (1); But drop out because parents prefer boys' education (1); Hence women's literacy is lower (1).	1+1+1
17	Women's bulk of work is household related, unpaid and invisible (1); Men's work mostly leads to income (1); Women work about one hour more per day on average (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Caste division is special to India (1); Gender is universal (1); Religion is widespread but not universal (1).	1+1+1
18	Caste groups need to enter coalitions with other castes and communities (1); This leads to negotiation (1); Smaller groups join bigger ones (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Voters assess government performance (1); Popularity of leaders matters (1); Party loyalty can be stronger than caste ties (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Religion as the principal basis of community (1); Everyday beliefs, dominance, mobilisation, violence (1); People have many identities (1); Interests of followers vary (1); It suppresses voices within the community (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Earlier: hereditary occupations, endogamy, untouchability (1); Reformers' efforts (1); Urbanisation, education, occupational mobility (1); Constitution bans discrimination (1); Yet caste still linked to economic status (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Literacy gap and dropout (1); Unequal wages despite law (1); Child sex ratio decline (1); Domestic violence and harassment (1); Under-representation in politics (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: Gender: universal, social not biological, political expression helps women (1); Religion: widespread, communal politics is dangerous (1); Caste: special to India (1); Each can be expressed in politics with positive or negative effect (1); Healthy expression gives space without hostility (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND